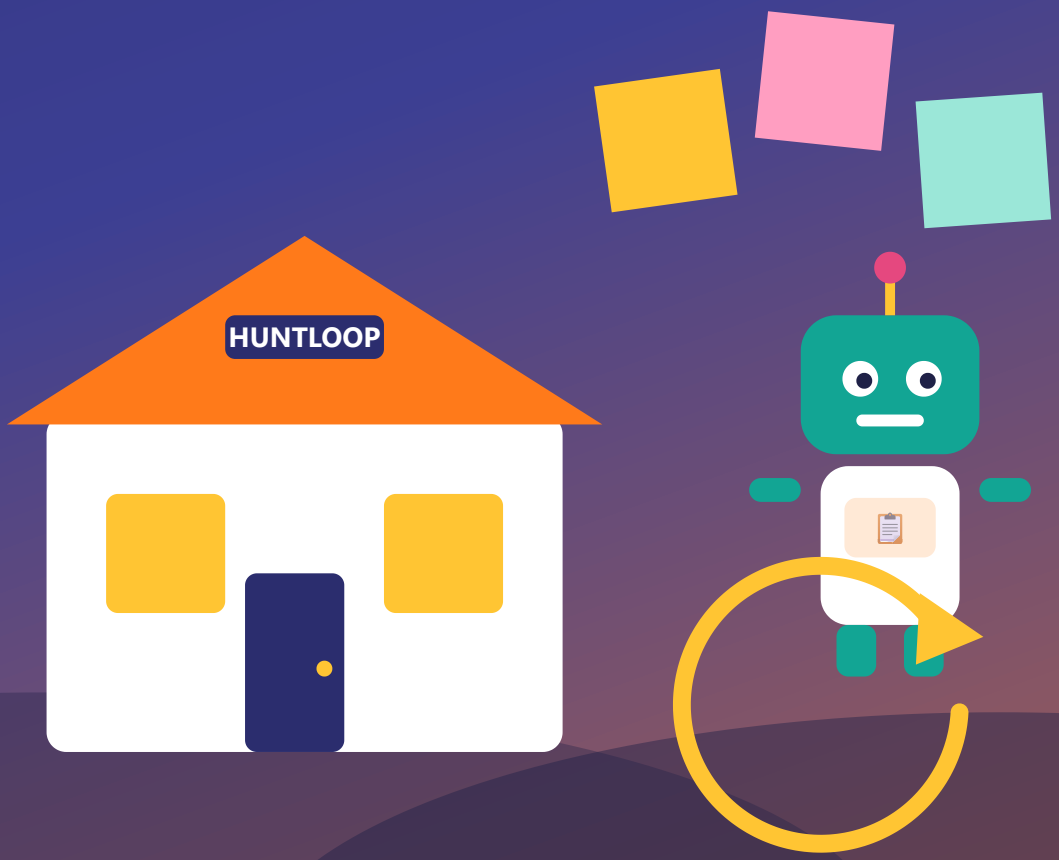
THE ILLUSTRATED GUIDE

How Huntloop Works

A friendly tour of the machine that finds the right customers, at the right moment — explained so anyone, even a 10-year-old, can follow along.

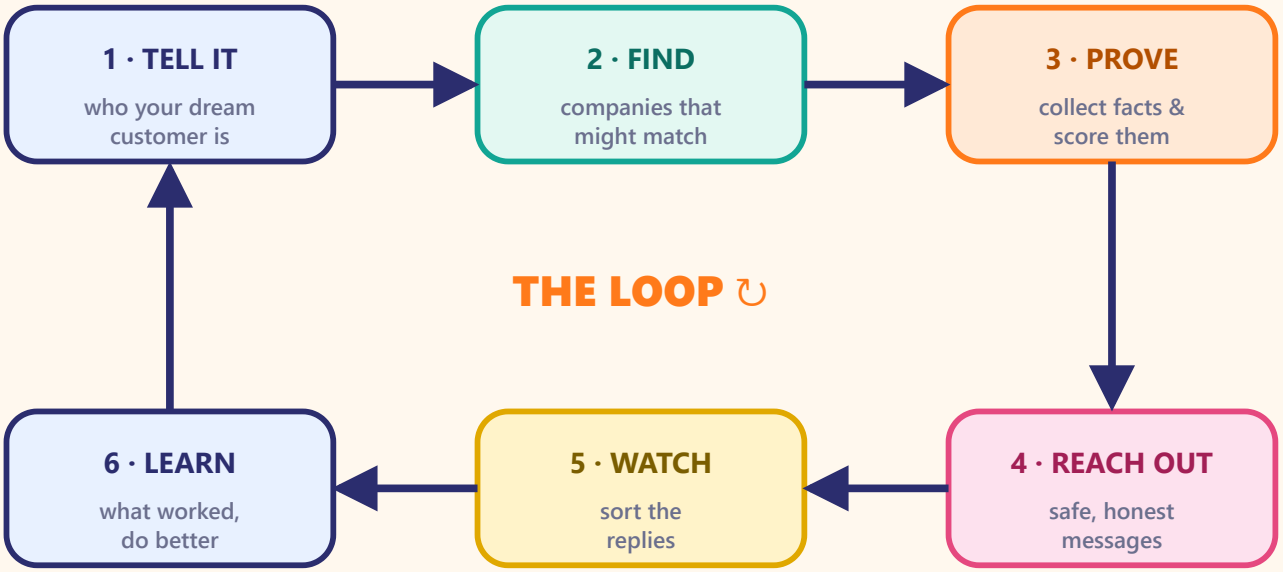


Based on the real Huntloop source code · investigation of 2026-10-30

1 The big idea

Imagine you run a **lemonade stand**. You don't shout at everybody. You look for people who are **hot, thirsty and have a dollar** — *right now*.

Huntloop does exactly this, but for **businesses that sell to other businesses**. You tell it what you sell and who would love it (your **ideal customer**). Then it hunts, checks the proof, and helps you reach out — carefully.



Why a loop? What Huntloop learns at step 6 makes step 2 and 3 smarter next time. It never really "finishes" — it keeps getting better.

Honest note. This guide describes what the code is *built* to do. The real AI and real data sources have **not yet been switched on** in the place I checked, so treat it as a very well-built machine tested with pretend parts — not yet driven on the road.

2 Meet the helpers

Think of Huntloop as a busy **clubhouse**. Here's who works inside.



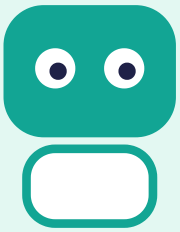
The To-Do Board

A giant wall of sticky notes. Each note is one small job. (In code: a database table called `job_executions`.)



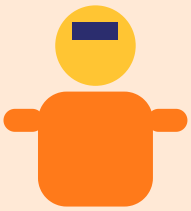
The Alarm Clock

Rings every **5 minutes**. It pokes a secret door that only opens with a password.



The Worker

Grabs up to **5 notes** and does them one at a time. Has about a minute, then must stop.



Hall Monitors

14 "sweepers" who walk around asking "what's due?" and **write new sticky notes**.



The Deep Thinker

A big, careful AI (**Opus**). Reads one company slowly and grades it.



The Quick Reader

A small, fast AI (**Haiku**). Skims news articles and sorts replies.



The Phone Books

Outside data companies (**Apollo, Hunter, ZeroBounce**). Look up companies, people and emails — for "coins" called credits.



The Mail Carrier

Connects to **Gmail or Outlook** to send your messages and read the replies.

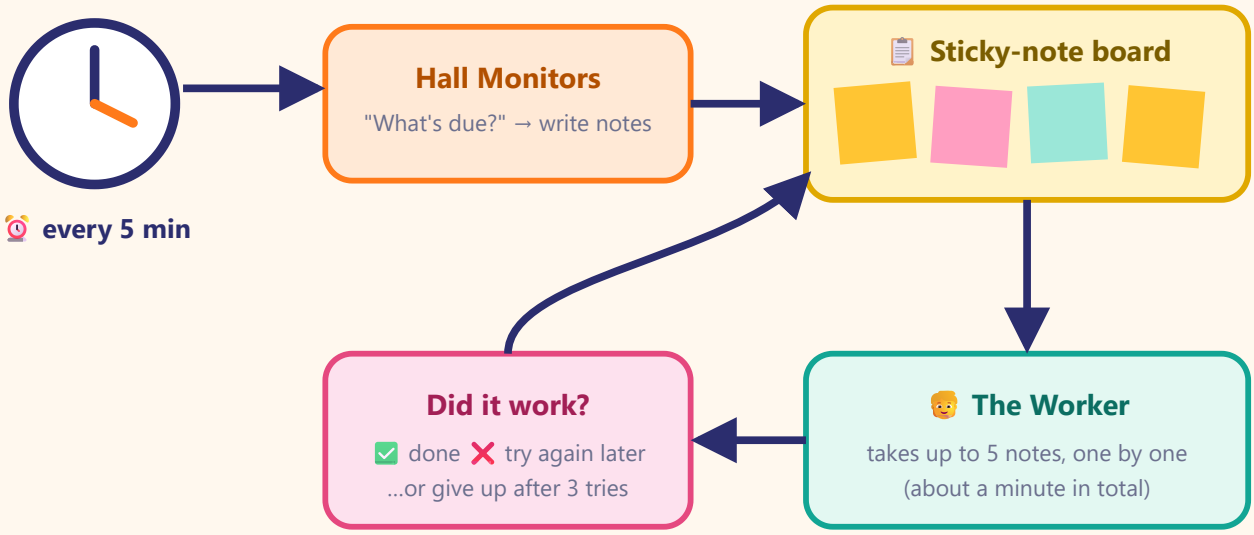


The Vault

The database (**Postgres / Supabase**). A locked cabinet with **one drawer per customer**.

3 Sticky notes and an alarm clock

Nothing in Huntloop runs "all day long." It works in short bursts, like this:



Failed notes go back on the board...

⏳ Waiting longer each time

If a note fails, it waits **1 minute**, then **4**, then **9**... (up to an hour). After **3 tries** it gives up. If a job is *impossible* (like a web address that doesn't exist) it is cancelled right away.

😴 If the Worker falls asleep

After **10 minutes** a stuck note is put back on the board for someone else. Nothing is lost.

🙅 No double work

Every note has a **name tag**. If ten articles mention the same company, the board says "already have that one!" and writes just **one** scoring note.

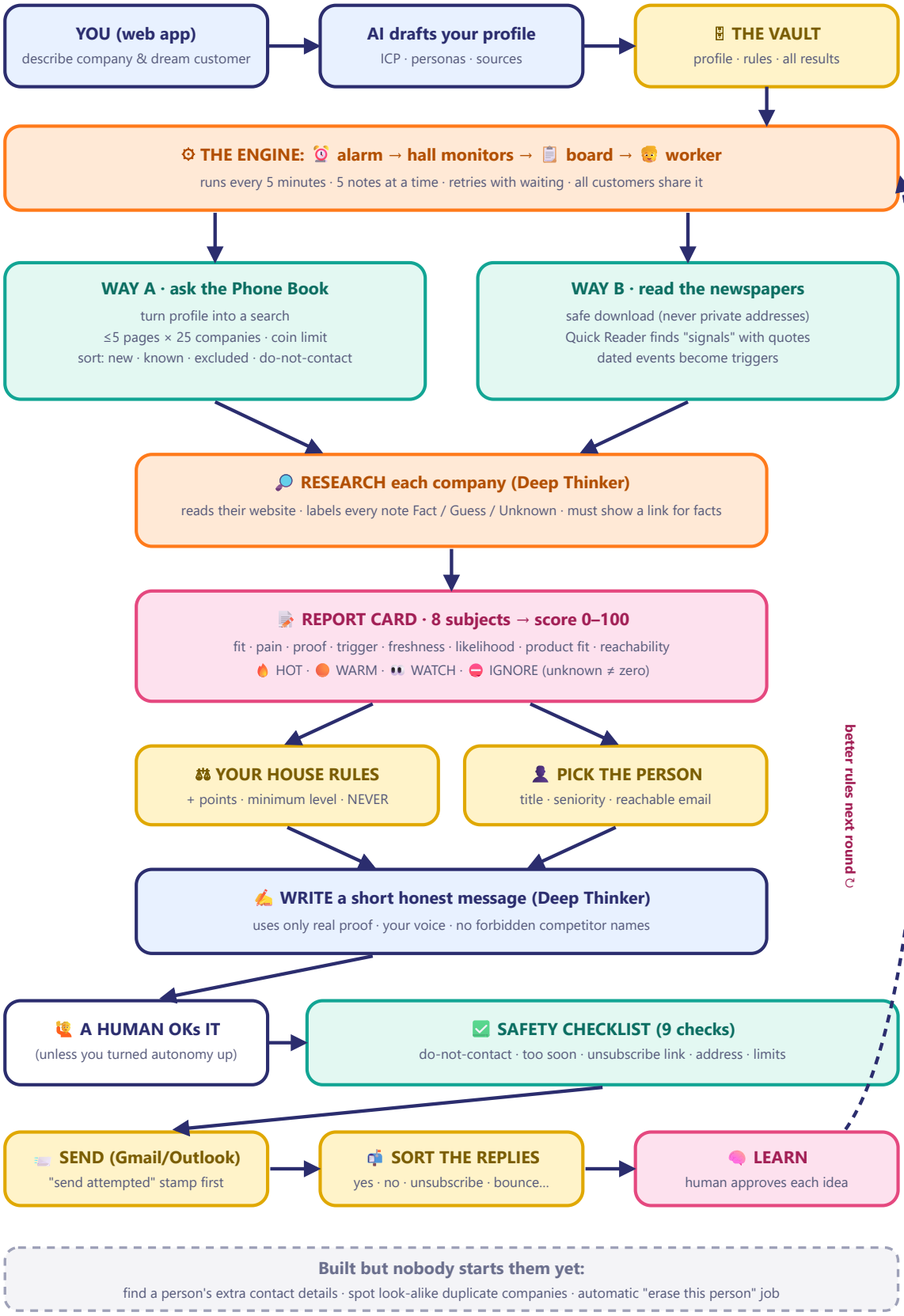
🔑 The secret door

The alarm needs a **password**. A wrong password gets "no such door" — so nobody can even tell the door exists.

> **Honest limit:** one worker doing 5 notes every 5 minutes is **slow** — like one cashier in a huge shop. Fine for a few customers; it would need upgrading for many.

The complete system map

Follow the arrows from the top. Each coloured box is a real part of the code. Dashed grey boxes exist but nothing starts them yet.



4 Step 1 — Finding companies

Way A · Ask the Phone Book

Huntloop turns your dream-customer description into a **search** and asks a data company: "*Give me 25 like this.*"

- Reads up to **5 pages** (125 companies)
- Has a **coin limit** so it can't blow your budget
- Remembers where it stopped, so a crash doesn't repeat work
- Saved answers are reused — **never pay twice** for the same question

Way B · Read the newspapers

On a schedule (once a day unless you change it), Huntloop visits the sources **you** picked.

- **Bouncer first:** it checks the address is public — twice! — so it can't be tricked into peeking at private places
- Downloads fast & small (15 s, 4 MB)
- Quick Reader notes "signals" and **must quote the exact words**
- Articles under ~200 letters aren't sent to the AI at all

Every company found goes into exactly one pile



Nothing is secretly thrown away. If the data company is broken or out of coins, Huntloop says "*refused / failed*" — it never pretends the market is empty.

Same company, different spelling? Huntloop cleans web addresses (removes `www.`, paths, etc.). Two "Apex" companies in different countries are **not** treated as the same. A gentle "maybe duplicate" check exists, but nothing starts it yet.

5 Step 2 — Understanding each company

The **Deep Thinker** reads the company's own website and writes notes. Every single note wears one of three badges:



FACT

"I **saw** it — here's the link."

No link? It can't be a fact.



GUESS

"I think so, from **clues**."

Marked with how sure it is.



UNKNOWN

"I honestly **don't know**."

Never pretends to be sure.

> **Strict honesty:** a "fact" that doesn't come from the company's *own* website is automatically **downgraded to a guess**. And research only fills **empty** boxes — it never overwrites something a person typed.

Why-now: the trigger

A **trigger** is something that just happened — a company raised money, opened a new office, is hiring lots of people. It's the "right now" in "right customer, right now."

📰 **"Acme raised $20M on May 3"**

has a DATE

→ becomes a TRIGGER ✅

🏠 **"We help teams grow"**

no date, from a website

→ just a note (no trigger)

Why no date = no trigger?

It would look "fresh" forever — that would be cheating.

> **If there's no AI key,** Huntloop shows a worked *example* clearly labeled as an example. It never makes pretend results look real.

6 Step 3 — The report card

The Deep Thinker grades each company on **8 school subjects** from 0 to 100 — or writes **"unknown."**

#	Subject	Kid question
1	ICP fit	Right kind of company?
2	Problem severity	How big is their problem?
3	Evidence strength	How good is our proof?
4	Trigger strength	Did something big happen?
5	Trigger freshness	Was it recent?
6	Buying likelihood	Will they actually buy?
7	Product relevance	Does ours fit them?
8	Reachability	Can we reach the decider?

Unknown ≠ zero!

0 means "we checked — it's bad."
Unknown means "we haven't found out."
Huntloop never mixes these up.

🛡 The AI can't cheat

It **cannot** say HOT unless it really worked out the fit, the pain *and* the trigger. If it tries, Huntloop rejects the answer.

...and one of four campfire labels



Honest note: the total score is the AI's carefully-checked *opinion*. There is no secret math formula, and no "answer key" yet proving the scores are right — which is why a human can always override.

7 Step 4 — House rules & the right person

⚖️ Your house rules

You can add rules that run **after** the AI, in plain math — no guessing:

- **ADD** "+10 points if they use Salesforce"
- **MINIMUM** "treat healthcare as at least WARM"
- **NEVER** "skip companies under 5 people"

A rule can move a score by at most ±40. Huntloop keeps a **receipt** of exactly which rules fired.

👤 Who should we talk to?

Each person at the company gets a mini-score:

- ❌ Left the company? **Skipped.**
- Job title fits the buyer? **(×3)**
- Senior enough? Right department? **(×2 each)**
- Trusted email, checked recently? **(counts a lot)**

Score **70+** = decision-maker. If a human already picked someone, Huntloop **never overrules** them.

How a score is built



Both numbers (the AI's and the final) are saved, plus the receipt — so you can always see *why* it moved.

8 Step 5 — Writing & the safety checklist

✍️ The message

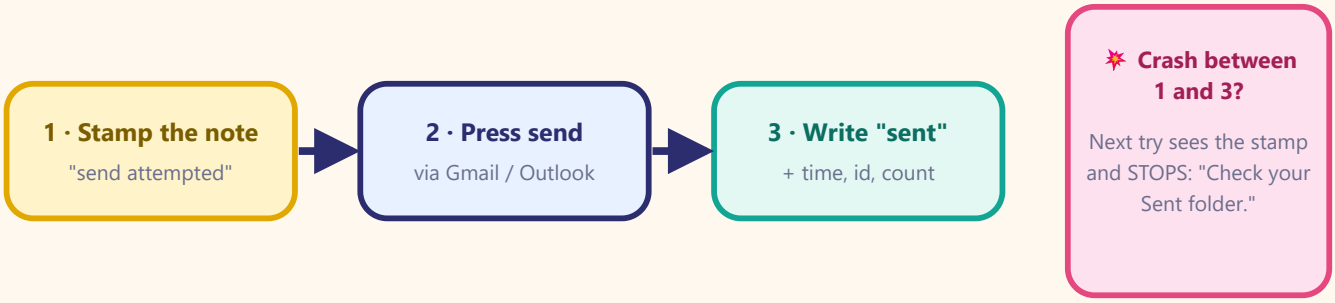
- Short — about **150 words** at most
- Uses **only real proof** and says which proof it used
- Written in **your** voice, and learns your edits
- Can't name competitors it's not allowed to mention
- Broke a rule? The draft is **rejected**

At low autonomy a **human approves every message** first.

✅ Pilot's checklist before sending

- ☐ Approved by a person?
- ☐ Goes to **one** real address?
- ☐ Not on the **do-not-contact** list?
- ☐ Not emailed **too recently**?
- ☐ Under the monthly cap per person?
- ☐ Company's daily limit OK?
- ☐ Working **unsubscribe** link?
- ☐ Real **postal address** included?
- ☐ Email allowance left? Mailbox has room today?

The "never send twice" trick



Better to send zero than two. A duplicate email can't be un-sent, so Huntloop picks the safe mistake.

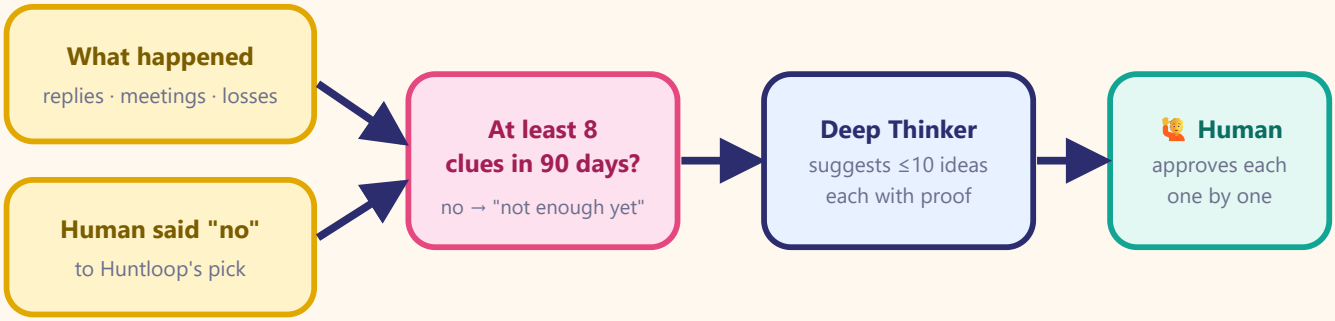
9 Steps 6 & 7 — Replies and learning

📬 The mail sorter

A small, fast AI puts every reply into a bin, and Huntloop reacts:

Bin	What Huntloop does
😀 **Positive** — "Yes, tell me more!"	Stops the sequence, **tells a human**
😐 **Neutral** — "Thanks."	Keeps going
🙅 **No / wrong person**	Stops
✋ **"Unsubscribe me"**	Stops **and never emails them again** (this beats every other bin)
🌴 **Out of office**	It's a robot, not an answer — waits
📪 **Bounce** — address broken	Stops, marks the address bad

🧠 The coach watches the game



✍️ It learns your style

Shorten its emails the same way **3 times** and it starts writing shorter for you.

🔁 Then it re-checks

An approved idea becomes a new rule; old companies are re-scored with it — and a receipt shows what changed.

> **Honest note:** "learning" here is an AI reading a small pile of results — not a math test. That's exactly why a human signs off on every idea.

10 Keeping everyone's stuff private

Many companies share Huntloop. Each one's information lives in its **own locked room**.

🚪 **Front door — checks who you are**

🧭 **Wrong room? Answer is "doesn't exist" — never "forbidden"**

🗄️ **The vault itself refuses to show other people's rows (the REAL lock)**

🔐 **Email passwords are stored scrambled (AES-256)**

Things Huntloop will <u>not</u> do — on purpose

- ❌ Make up proof — unknown stays unknown
- ❌ Pretend it has an AI key when it doesn't
- ❌ Spend past your coin limit
- ❌ Email anyone on the do-not-contact list
- ❌ Send the same email twice by accident
- ❌ Overrule a choice you made by hand
- ❌ Visit private internet addresses
- ❌ Keep data you asked it to erase (it keeps only a scrambled "don't contact" fingerprint)

> **Your rights, built in:** every email has an unsubscribe link; people can be erased and exported; you can set how long contact data is kept (off by default — Huntloop won't delete your data unless *you* choose a number).

! The honest list: what isn't proven yet

Thing	What it means in plain words
Never run "for real"	The AI, data companies and Gmail/Outlook were only tested with *pretend* versions. A car that passed every test on the stand but hasn't driven on a road.
Three helpers nobody calls	Finding extra contact details, spotting look-alike duplicate companies, and the automatic erase-a-person job all exist — but no sticky note ever starts them.
A slow worker	5 jobs every 5 minutes, one at a time, shared by *every* customer. One slow AI call can eat the whole minute.
Only one phone book per job	If the data company is down or out of coins, there is no backup company to ask.
Scores are an opinion	Carefully checked for consistency, but nothing yet proves they predict who really buys.
Learning from tiny samples	It reads a few results rather than running a statistics test — so humans approve every idea.
Websites made with fancy scripts	The newspaper-reader can't "run" a page, so some modern sites look empty to it.
No way to pay yet	Plans (Free / Growth / Scale) exist, but there's no checkout.
Database updates done by hand	No automatic tracker of which updates are applied; the setup notes lagged behind the code when I looked.
No alarm if the alarm stops	If the 5-minute clock stops, nothing warns anyone. Work just quietly piles up.

> **Where did all this come from?** I read the real program: the sticky-note board and worker, the newspaper reader, the AI-grading code, the rules, contact ranking, the sending safety checks, the data-company wrapper and more. I did **not** read every screen of the website or the inside of each data company's connector — the technical document marks those clearly.

A–Z Glossary

Word	Easy meaning
ICP	"Ideal Customer Profile" — a description of the *perfect customer*.
Opportunity	A company that might become a customer, with all its proof attached.
Evidence	A note that's a fact, a guess, or "don't know," with a link to where it came from.
Trigger / Signal	Signal = a hint in an article. Trigger = a *dated* event that makes now a good time.
Score / Priority	A 0–100 number / the HOT-WARM-WATCH-IGNORE label.
Rule / Veto	Something *you* set: add points, set a minimum, or "NEVER" (veto).
Persona	The kind of person you want to reach ("Head of Sales").
Decision-maker	The person who can say "yes, let's buy."
Enrichment	Filling in missing details (size, industry, email) from a data company.
Provider / Credits	A company that sells data / the "coins" it charges per lookup.
Cache	A saved answer, so we never pay twice for the same question.
Circuit breaker	If a service keeps failing, stop calling it for a while — like switching off a broken toaster.
Queue / Job	The line of waiting work / one piece of it (a sticky note).
Sweeper	A job that looks for what's due and creates more jobs (a hall monitor).
Tick	One round of: alarm rings → worker does up to 5 jobs.
Idempotent	"Doing it twice is as good as doing it once."
Model / AI / Prompt	The smart text program (here: Claude) / the instructions you give it.
RSS feed	A page listing a site's newest articles, for computers to read.
Suppression list	The "do not contact" list.
Bounce	An email that couldn't be delivered.
Autonomy level	How much Huntloop may do without asking (0 = ask for everything).
Tenant	One customer company using Huntloop (one locked room).
RLS	"Row Level Security" — the database only shows you your own rows.
Encryption	Scrambling a secret so only the right key can read it.
SSRF guard	The bouncer that stops Huntloop being tricked into visiting private addresses.
Migration	An update to the shape of the database.

More detail: **HUNTLOOP_ENGINE_EXPLAINED.md** (technical) · **HUNTLOOP_ENGINE_ARCHITECTURE.md** (diagrams) · **HUNTLOOP_ENGINE_SIMPLE_GUIDE.md** (this guide as text).